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US equities rise modestly as yields slip and earnings beat expectations

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The major indices closed higher on Friday, with the **S&P 500** up +0.28% to 7,743.98 and the **Nasdaq 100** gaining +0.55% to 29,813.16. Yield pressure eased, the 10-year Treasury fell to 5.05%, supporting risk assets.

Key drivers were a better-than-expected earnings beat from **AVGO** (+2.77%) and a modest dip in the VIX to 16.91. Watch for upcoming CPI data and the Fed’s policy outlook later this week.

US Session Recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,743.98	+0.28%	Broad rally
Dow Jones	52,475.10	+0.19%	Industrial support
Nasdaq 100	29,813.16	+0.55%	Tech led
Russell 2000	2,830.51	+0.41%	Small-cap steady
VIX	16.91	-3.48%	Volatility easing
10Y Yield	5.05%	+1.04%	Yield dip
WTI Crude	101.48	-1.26%	Oil pullback

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
AVGO	351.81	+2.77%
GS	925.17	+1.47%
JPM	339.30	+1.05%
GOOGL	324.89	+1.34%
AMZN	254.60	+0.59%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	`AVGO`
Q3 EPS	`$3.12` vs $2.95 est
Revenue	`$7.84` bn (+5.1%)
Guidance	FY24 revenue +6% to $33 bn

Broadcom beat both earnings and revenue estimates, driven by strong data-center chip demand. The upbeat FY24 outlook lifted the semiconductor sector and helped the `XLK` ETF rise **+0.80%**.

Macro & Fed

- Fed policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: `5.05%`
- Today's releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, PCE 03:00, Fed Chair remarks 04:30

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions remain low; oil inventories rising, supporting modest price decline.
- China’s manufacturing PMI posted 49.8, indicating continued contraction.
- Eurozone inflation eases to 2.6% YoY, prompting speculation of earlier rate cuts.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
Oct 30 01:30	`MSFT`	Cloud growth vs guidance
Oct 30 02:00	`AAPL`	iPhone demand trends
Oct 31 01:00	`NVDA`	AI chip inventory levels
Oct 31 02:30	`META`	Ad revenue recovery

Stocks worth watching

- `MSFT` – Cloud margin expansion after strong Azure uptake.
- `AAPL` – Potential iPhone 17 launch impact on revenue.
- `NVDA` – Inventory drawdown could boost margins.
- `XLF` – Bank earnings beat may lift financials.
- `XLE` – Oil price dip tests energy exposure.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected rise in CPI (>0.3% MoM) could reignite rate-hike expectations.
- Weak earnings from `NVDA` or `META` pulling tech lower.
- Escalation in Middle-East conflict spiking oil above $110.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Fed Chair signals pause on tightening.
- Strong Q3 results from **`MSFT`** or **`AAPL`**.
- Eurozone data shows faster inflation decline, prompting rate-cut bets.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — Broadcom Earnings

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